

1. Administrative & Study Identification

Full Study Title: Concept Elicitation and Patient Experience Mapping in Sepsis-associated Acute Kidney Injury **Short Title/ Acronym:** Concept Elicitation and Patient Experience Mapping in SA-AKI **Protocol Number:** CTIN816B12002 **NCT Number:** NCT07180238 **Sponsor Name:** Novartis Pharmaceuticals **Investigational Product:** N/A (Non-interventional qualitative interview study) **Phase of Development:** N/A (Observational) **Medical Monitor:** Novartis Clinical Operations Lead

2. Study Synopsis & Rationale

2.1 Study Objective **Primary Objective:** To elicit concepts of interests in patients who experienced Sepsis-associated Acute Kidney Injury (SA-AKI). **Secondary Objectives:** To map experiences from patient and caregiver perspectives, including treatment pathways and barriers to SA-AKI treatment, the burden of SA-AKI and unmet needs, and the disease's humanistic, societal, and economic impacts.

2.2 Background & Rationale To understand the experiences of patients who have had SA-AKI and their caregivers, identify unmet needs, treatment barriers, and the broader humanistic, societal, and economic impacts of the disease. This understanding could lead to better support and care strategies for people dealing with SA-AKI by highlighting areas for improved interventions in the future.

3. Study Design & Methodology

3.1 Design Framework **Study Type:** Observational (Cross-sectional, non-interventional qualitative interview study) **Control Type:** N/A **Blinding:** N/A **Randomization:** N/A

3.2 Planned Enrollment & Duration **Target** **\$N\$:** Up to 30 people (patients and caregivers) **Number of Sites:** Multi-national (US and Germany) **Estimated Study Start:** 01-May-2025 **Estimated Primary Completion:** 30-Sep-2025

4. Subject Selection (Eligibility Criteria)

4.1 Inclusion Criteria 1. Age ≥ 18 to ≤ 85 years. 2. First diagnosis of SA-AKI (KDIGO stage I, II or III) at least 6 months prior to the screening date, but no more than 10 years. 3.

Admitted due to sepsis and/or AKI to an intensive care unit (ICU), intermediate care unit (IMCU), or high-dependency care unit, or developed sepsis and/or AKI during their inpatient hospital stay.

(Note: Study also includes caregivers aged 18-85 who are primary care-partners for eligible participants)

4.2 Exclusion Criteria 1. Less than the age of majority in locality (Participant is not considered an adult in their country or region). 2. Not willing to participate in an audio-recorded interview. 3. Not able to participate in the interview or complete required study surveys, based on the discretion of the study team.

5. Intervention & Treatment Plan

5.1 Investigational Regimen Dosage/Frequency: N/A (Single virtual, hybrid 60-minute semi-structured concept elicitation (CE) and patient experience interview) **Route of Administration:** N/A **Duration of Treatment:** Single 60-minute session

5.2 Concomitant & Prohibited Therapy Permitted: N/A **Prohibited:** N/A

6. Study Timeline & Visit Schedule

Visit ID	Window (Days)	Key Activities/Procedures	:---
:---	:---	Screening	Day -14 to 0 Informed Consent, Eligibility screening, Confirmation of Diagnosis (COD) via medical records or physician confirmation. Baseline Day 0 Virtual 60-minute semi-structured audio-recorded interview. Interim N/A N/A End of Study Day 0 Completion of interview and required study surveys.

7. Outcome Measures (Endpoints)

7.1 Primary Endpoint Definition: Concept elicitation of patient experiences with SA-AKI. **Measurement Method:** Thematic analysis of coded transcripts from the 60-minute audio-recorded interviews.

7.2 Secondary & Exploratory Endpoints Mapping experiences from patient and caregiver perspectives. Identifying treatment pathways, barriers to treatment, unmet needs, and the disease's humanistic, societal, and economic impacts.

8. Safety & Adverse Event Reporting

Adverse Event (AE) Monitoring: Minimal risk study. Standard reporting protocols apply if any untoward events occur during the interview. **Serious Adverse Events (SAEs):** N/A **Data Monitoring Committee (DMC):** N/A

9. Statistical Analysis Plan (SAP) Summary

Analysis Populations: Interviewed participants (Patients and Caregivers). **Sample Size Justification:** Up to 30 participants, sized to reach qualitative thematic saturation in concept elicitation. **Handling of Missing Data:** N/A

10. Quality Assurance & Regulatory Compliance

GCP Compliance: This study will be conducted in accordance with Good Clinical Practice (GCP) and the Declaration of Helsinki. **Monitoring Plan:** Transcripts will be reviewed by analysts and analyzed according to a predefined qualitative analysis plan. **Audit Trail:** All personal information will be kept confidential, and information will be stored on a secure network which is only accessible to the study team.

11. Study Identifiers & Governance

Primary ID: CTIN816B12002 **Registry Number:** NCT07180238 _ **Sponsor/Lead Organization:** Novartis Pharmaceuticals **Study Title:** Concept Elicitation and Patient Experience Mapping in SA-AKI **Official Regulatory Title:** Concept Elicitation and Patient Experience Mapping in Sepsis-associated Acute Kidney Injury

12. Clinical Framework (SA-AKI Specific)

Primary Condition: Sepsis-associated Acute Kidney Injury (SA-AKI) **Diagnosis Threshold:** KDIGO stage I, II or III **Medical Methodology:** Qualitative concept elicitation and patient experience mapping **Optimization Target:** Identification of unmet needs, barriers to treatment, and humanistic/societal impacts

13. Study Procedures & Methodology

Management Pathway: N/A - Non-interventional **Education Protocol (HCP):** N/A **Education Protocol (Patient):** N/A **Quality Audit Mechanism:** Qualitative thematic analysis of coded transcripts by designated analysts

14. Observation & Follow-Up Schedule

Total Duration: Single 60-minute interview **Onsite Visit Cadence:** N/A (Virtual / Hybrid) **Remote Monitoring Frequency:** N/A **Checklist Review Interval:** N/A

15. Sign-off & Approval

Role	Name	Signature	Date	:---	:---	:---	:---
Principal Investigator	[Name]	_____	[DD-MMM-YYYY]				
Clinical Operations Lead	[Name]	_____	[DD-MMM-YYYY]				Lead
Statistician	[Name]	_____	[DD-MMM-YYYY]				